



Transfusion Policy Manual

Transfusion Sample Collection and Labelling

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
SCGOPHCG	Organisation Wide	Clinical staff

Introduction

Adherence to transfusion sampling and labelling requirements is crucial to patient safety.¹ Positive patient identification and complete transfusion request documentation and sample labelling is imperative to ensure right patient and right product. The outcomes should these

Breach legislative requirements	☐	Impact on Patient Quality of Care	☒
Breach National/State/Hospital Policy	☒	Impact on Patient Safety	☒
Breach professional standards	☒	Misconduct	☐
Breach SCGOPHCG Mission & Values	☐	Staff Safety	☐
Other:	☐		

requirements not be upheld can be devastating to patients and families.

Risk Statement

Non-compliance with this policy will:

Definitions

GAS	Group and Antibody Screen: blood sample that establishes the patient's blood group and tests for any blood group antibodies
XM	Crossmatch: in transfusion medicine terms refers to the testing that is performed to determine the compatibility of a donated unit of blood with its intended recipient.

Policy Principles

A valid patient GAS sample is required to be available at the site where the transfusion will be administered to allow for the crossmatch request to be processed.

Pre transfusion samples and requests must be completed utilising correct patient identification and labelling procedures in accordance with the [Australian and New Zealand Society of Blood Transfusion](#) guidelines and the [National Pathology Accreditation Advisory Council Requirements for Transfusion Laboratory Practice](#) to ensure safe blood sample collection for ABO blood group and antibody screening.

This policy should be read in conjunction with the [SCGOPHCG Patient Identification](#) policy.

For emergency department transfusion sample collection and requests utilising eOrder, refer to [Appendix 1](#). Transfusion sample collection and specimen labelling should always occur at the bedside.

Procedure

Failure to perform positive patient identification and label the blood samples at the patient's bedside is a high risk to patient safety and may result in a patient receiving an incompatible blood transfusion.

1.0 Transfusion Sample Request forms

All patient transfusion sample (GAS) request forms must legibly contain the following:

1. Patient surname, first name in full
2. Hospital record number
3. Date of birth
4. Printed name, provider number and signature of requesting doctor
5. Date of request
6. Location of patient

If XM is requested the following should also be provided:

7. The type of blood product and number of units required
8. Date and time the blood product is required (include date of surgery if applicable)
9. Past transfusion or obstetric history (if known)
10. Request details which must include the reason for transfusion in accordance with the [National Blood Authority Patient Blood Management Guidelines](#)

Transfusion sample and crossmatch request form options

1. A4 PathWest "Transfusion Medicine Request" Form (PREFERRED)- [APPENDIX 2](#)
2. CPOE iCM pathology request form- [APPENDIX 3](#)
3. CPOE downtime form- [APPENDIX 4](#)

2.0 Obtaining a blood sample for GAS and XM

Positive Patient Identification Requirements

- Patient identity must be confirmed by **ASKING** the patient to state their FULL NAME, DATE OF BIRTH and ADDRESS if they are rational and conscious. The collector must check these details match the patient's identity band and the request form.
- If the patient is unable to confirm their identity, a carer, relative, next of kin or significant other can identify the patient.

Sample tube labelling requirements

Patient sample must be legibly labelled with the following:

- Patient surname, first name in full
- Hospital record number and / or date of birth
- Date and time of collection
- Collector's initial/signature (must match that of the collectors' declaration on the request form)

The sample **MUST** be labelled at the patient bedside

The sample tube **MUST NOT** be pre-labelled prior to venepuncture and positive identification of the patient.

The sample **MUST NOT** be given to another person to label.

PathWest Transfusion Medicine Unit (TMU) has a “**Zero Tolerance**” approach.

- Samples without patient surname, first name and hospital record number or date of birth will be discarded and a recollect will be requested.
- Date & time of collection and signature of the collector must appear on the sample tube label and match that of the collectors’ declaration or it will be discarded and a recollect will be requested.
- The request form and sample tube must carry identical patient identification or it will be discarded and a recollect will be requested.
- The requesting doctor will be informed of an inadequately labelled sample or a discrepancy between sample and request form.
- Sample exteriors grossly contaminated with blood or body fluid etc will be discarded by the laboratory without being analysed. The ward or medical officer will be notified of this action and further samples must be provided for testing. In **EXTREME** clinical urgency, exceptions to this rule can be made.
- For patients with a valid group and screen, a verbal request from a doctor can be accepted by TMU to order blood products. The contact number is:

SCGH: Pathwest TMU is 6383 4018 OPH: Pathwest is 6457 8088

Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Non-adherence to this policy may result in delays in patient treatment, repeat interventions, or adverse patient outcomes. The SCGOPHCG Blood Management Committee is responsible for ensuring the effectiveness of this policy and compliance in reviewed at each BMC meeting utilising data collated via the PathWest Sample Quality Power BI dashboard.

Related Documents

Authorising Policy and Standard/s:

- NSQHS Standard 7 Blood Management
- NSQHS Standard 6 Communicating for Safety

Standards, procedures, guidelines:

- [ANZSBT Guidelines for Transfusion and Immunohaematology laboratory practice](https://anzsbt.org.au/guidelines/guidelines-for-transfusion-and-immunohaematology-laboratory-practice/)
- [SCGOPHCG Patient Identification](#)

References

1. Australian and New Zealand society of blood transfusion, Australian College of Nursing. Guidelines for transfusion and immunohaematology laboratory practice 2nd edition (Internet). Australian & New Zealand Society of Blood Transfusion Ltd; 2025 Jun (cited 2025 December 02). Available from: <https://anzsbt.org.au/guidelines/guidelines-for-transfusion-and-immunohaematology-laboratory-practice/>
2. National Pathology Accreditation Advisory Council. Requirements for Transfusion Laboratory Practice 4th edition (Internet). Canberra: Commonwealth of Australia Department of Health; 2019 (cited 2023 January 18). Available from https://www.safetyandquality.gov.au/sites/default/files/2022-08/tier_4_requirements_for_transfusion_laboratory_practice_fourth_edition_2019.pdf



- A group and screen can be ordered via the 'Bleeding/Pre-op/Trauma' or 'General' order set.
- Relevant clinical history should be provided e.g. 'active bleed' 'pregnant' 'haematological malignancy' 'transfused uncrossmatched blood during transport' 'previous transfusion reaction'



RESULTS & ENQUIRIES
6383 4018

April 4

PNF801 SCGH-0

APPENDIX 3

 PathWest LABORATORY MEDICINE WA ABN 83 469 340 804		RESULTS & ENQUIRIES 13 Path West APA	PATH 7284	PATHOLOGY REQUEST												
Patient UMRN: 		Order No: 														
UMRN: Medicare No: Surname: Given names: Middle name: Date of Birth: Age: Sex: Address:		Ward: Room: Bed: BA Scheduled: Consultant: Requesting Doctor: Provider Number:		Pregnancy Status: Yes / No / Unk Gestation: W D Anti-D Date: / / Fasting: Yes / No Anticoagulant: When collecting ANTIBIOTIC or DRUG assays fill in this box: <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Drug</th> <th>Dosage</th> <th>Date</th> <th>Time</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td> </td> <td> </td> <td> </td> <td> </td> </tr> <tr> <td> </td> <td> </td> <td> </td> <td> </td> </tr> </tbody> </table>	Drug	Dosage	Date	Time								
Drug	Dosage	Date	Time													
Test(s) requested Group and Screen		Request Date: Source: Site: Micro OE Comment: Antibiotic Therapy:		Tube/Container Count PINK 1 STERILE 1												
Report Copies to:		TRANSFUSION INFORMATION Transfusion in last 3 months? Yes / No Operation / Delivery: Date: Location:		Date of Collection / / Time of Collection : Collector's Declaration: I certify that the blood specimen(s) accompanying the request was drawn from the patient named above and I established the identity of this patient by direct enquiry and/or by inspection of wrist band, and immediately upon the blood being drawn I labelled the specimen(s). Sign: HE: Patient consents to result storage in the HDWA Clinical Information System (iCM). Patient Signature:												
CLINICAL NOTES: F) PRBC		NOTES:														

For your closest PathWest collection centre, please visit www.pathwest.health.wa.gov.au for latest information or telephone 13 72 84

APPENDIX 4

 PathWest LABORATORY MEDICINE WA Hospital Avenue Nedlands WA 6009 ABN 83 469 340 804		RESULTS & ENQUIRIES 13 Path West APA	PATH 7284	PATHOLOGY REQUEST																														
CPOE DOWN-TIME FORM Unit no. Medicare Number Surname Given Names Date of Birth Age Sex Address TESTS REQUESTED URGENT ☐ PHONE ☐ FAX ☐ Ph / Fax Number:		Consultant Requesting Doctor (surname and initials, provider number, address) Doctors Signature ☒ Request Date Page Copy Reports to: Fasting: Yes ☐ No ☐ Rule 3 Exemption: Yes ☐ No ☐ Anticoagulant Therapy Warfarin ☐ Heparin ☐ Patient's Signature for Ancillary Test: ☒																																
CLINICAL NOTES 		Source / Hospital SCGH Ward / Clinic Day For Collection M T W Thu F S Su When collecting ANTIBIOTIC or DRUG assays fill in this box: <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Drug</th> <th>Dosage</th> <th>Date</th> <th>Time</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td> </td> <td> </td> <td> </td> <td> </td> </tr> <tr> <td> </td> <td> </td> <td> </td> <td> </td> </tr> </tbody> </table> Date of Collection / / Time of Collection : <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>CLOT</th> <th>SST</th> <th>CIT</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>☐</td> <td>☐</td> <td>☐</td> </tr> <tr> <td>ACD</td> <td>HEP</td> <td>EDTA</td> </tr> <tr> <td>GLU</td> <td>ESR</td> <td>ABG</td> </tr> <tr> <td>URINE</td> <td>24 URINE</td> <td>SWAB</td> </tr> <tr> <td>SLIDE</td> <td>Other</td> <td></td> </tr> </tbody> </table> Collector's Signature ☒ I certify that the blood specimen(s) accompanying the request was drawn from the patient named above and I established the identity of this patient by direct enquiry and/or by inspection of wrist band and immediately upon the blood being drawn I labelled the specimen(s). Patient status at time of service or when specimens collected: 1. A private patient in a private hospital or approved day hospital facility YES NO ☐ 2. A private patient in a recognised hospital ☐ 3. A Medicare (public patient) in a recognised hospital ☐ 4. An outpatient of a recognised hospital ☐ RCPA PWF851 10/20			Drug	Dosage	Date	Time									CLOT	SST	CIT	☐	☐	☐	ACD	HEP	EDTA	GLU	ESR	ABG	URINE	24 URINE	SWAB	SLIDE	Other	
Drug	Dosage	Date	Time																															
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Results to be: ☐ Faxed ☐ Phoned																																		

Authorisation & Version Control

Policy Sponsor	Medical Co-Director Cancer and Imaging Services				
Policy Contact	Clinical Nurse Consultant Transfusion				
Date First Issued:	01/02/2014	Last Reviewed:	09/12/2025	Review Date:	02/12/2028
Version No.	5				
Approved by:	SCGOPHCG Blood Management Committee			Date:	09/12/2025
Endorsed by:	SCGOPHCG Blood Management Committee			Date:	09/12/2025
Standards Applicable	Insert relevant NSQHS Standards (Version 2):    				

For full details regarding, development, review, consultation, approval, endorsement - contact the Policy Officer for the submission form

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